

U.S. SEMICONDUCTOR: TRADE & LABOR ANALYSIS

Employment Cost Index — Raw Tables & Download Log (BLS ECI) | 2025 Q3

Overview

This document logs the Employment Cost Index (ECI) tables downloaded from the U.S. Bureau of Labor Statistics to support wage, benefit, and compensation analysis across industries, occupations, and regions. The ECI measures the change in the cost of labor — independent of employment shifts between occupations and industries — making it one of the most reliable indicators of underlying wage pressure in the U.S. economy.

All tables were obtained in PDF format as published by the BLS. Both seasonally adjusted and not seasonally adjusted series were collected to enable time-series comparisons, regional breakdowns, and alignment with QCEW employment and wage data.

Source & Release Information

Attribute	Value
Data provider	U.S. Bureau of Labor Statistics (BLS)
Publication	Employment Cost Index — 2025 Q3 Results
Release	Q3 2025 (latest available at time of collection)
Format	PDF tables (as published by BLS)
Adjustment types	Seasonally adjusted (SA) and Not seasonally adjusted (NSA)

Tables Downloaded

Table	Adjustment	Title	Analytical Purpose
Table 1	Seasonally Adjusted	Total compensation by ownership, occupational group, and industry	National baseline for total compensation trends across all worker categories
Table 2	Seasonally Adjusted	Wages and salaries by ownership, occupational group, and industry	Isolates the wage/salary component of compensation for direct cost comparison
Table 3	Seasonally Adjusted	Benefits by ownership, occupational group, and industry	Quantifies the non-wage cost of employment, including health, retirement, and paid leave
Table 10	Not Seasonally Adjusted	Wages and salaries for private industry workers by bargaining status and Census region/division	Reveals how union vs. non-union status and geography affect wage structures
Table 13	Not Seasonally Adjusted	Total compensation and wages/salaries for private industry workers by geographic area	Enables geographic comparisons, aligned with QCEW regional employment and wage data

Rationale for Table Selection

Tables 1–3: Seasonally Adjusted National Foundation

These three tables provide a consistent, seasonally adjusted foundation for analyzing national trends in total compensation, wages and salaries, and benefits separately. Using seasonally adjusted data removes cyclical noise, making quarter-over-quarter comparisons more meaningful and directly comparable across years.

Table 10: Bargaining Status & Regional Wage Structure

Table 10 adds insight into how union bargaining status and regional location affect wage levels for private industry workers. This is particularly relevant for semiconductor manufacturing analysis — a sector with mixed union presence and significant regional wage variation across U.S. fab locations.

Table 13: Geographic Compensation Comparison

Table 13 enables direct geographic comparisons of total compensation and wages across Census regions. This aligns with QCEW area-level employment data, allowing the two datasets to be used together for a comprehensive regional labor cost picture.

How These Tables Fit the Broader Analysis

Connection to QCEW Data

The ECI tables complement the QCEW dataset by providing a measure of compensation change that is independent of employment composition shifts. Where QCEW shows how many workers are employed and what total wages are paid, the ECI reveals whether the cost of employing a given type of worker is rising or falling — controlling for the mix of jobs.

Connection to Semiconductor Trade Analysis

Labor costs are a key determinant of nearshoring viability. As companies evaluate shifting semiconductor production to the U.S. or its trading partners, understanding wage trends by industry and region — especially in manufacturing and engineering occupations — is essential for accurate cost modeling and competitive benchmarking.

Connection to Tariff & Trade Policy Analysis

Rising labor costs in the U.S. interact with tariff structures to shape the total landed cost of domestic versus imported semiconductors. ECI data provides the labor cost side of this equation, while the tariff analysis (HS 85423100) provides the trade policy side.

Key Design Choices

- **Both SA and NSA series collected:** Seasonally adjusted tables (1–3) support trend analysis and time-series comparisons. Not seasonally adjusted tables (10, 13) are used for point-in-time regional comparisons where seasonal adjustment is less critical.
- **PDF format retained as-is:** BLS ECI tables are published in formatted PDF layouts. Retaining the original PDFs ensures auditability and allows verification against the official source at any point.
- **Q3 2025 as anchor period:** The Q3 2025 release was the latest available at the time of data collection, providing the most current snapshot of compensation trends for 2025 analysis.

- **Five tables selected:** The selection covers total compensation, its wage and benefit components, bargaining status effects, and geographic variation — providing comprehensive coverage without redundancy.

Data Source

[U.S. Bureau of Labor Statistics — Employment Cost Index](#)